HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

# My Plan for Replacing "I don't belong in church because of my past"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

## 1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

*Rate it now so you can see your progress later.*

"I don't belong in church because of my past." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

## 2 My best question

*The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.*

- ☐ What in my past worries me?
- ☐ What does God say about it?
- ☐ Whom did Jesus welcome?
- ☐ What church welcomes sinners?
- ☐ Who is a safe believer?
- ☐ What is my next step?

My own question: _____

## 3 My replacement truth

*The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.*

- ☐ I was washed, sanctified, and justified.
- ☐ Jesus welcomes sinners.
- ☐ I am a new creation.
- ☐ Much forgiven, I love much.
- ☐ I can approach the throne of grace.
- ☐ My past is not my identity.

In my own words: _____

## 4 My Scripture

*The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.*

- ☐ 1 Corinthians 6:11
  *"And that is what some of you were. But you were washed, you were sanctified, you were justified, in the name of the Lord Jesus Christ and by the Spirit of our God."*
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 5:17
  *"Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!"*
- ☐ Hebrews 4:16
  *"Let us then approach the throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need."*

A verse I found myself: _____

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# Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

## 5 My practice plan

*Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.*

### EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

### PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Forgiven and welcome: Each week, record one moment of welcome or one truth about forgiveness.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  *For example, 1 Corinthians 6:11 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I was washed and justified, so I belong.""*
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Forgiveness" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

## 6 My action step this week

*Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.*

*Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.*

- [ ] Write your fear. State what you think would happen if people knew your past.
- [ ] Confess and receive. Bring unresolved sin to God and receive forgiveness.
- [ ] Visit a welcoming church. Look for one that talks openly about grace.
- [ ] Tell one safe person. Share your story with a mature believer.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

## 7 End-of-week check-in

*Bring this page to your next session.*

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I don't belong in church because of my past": _____ % My truth: _____ %

## Daily practice tracker

| Day | Read my card | Said my verse | Used my reminder | A step toward welcome |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | |
| Tue | | | | |
| Wed | | | | |
| Thu | | | | |
| Fri | | | | |
| Sat | | | | |
| Sun | | | | |

## My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

| Day | Song I listened to | What it told me that challenges the lie |
|---|---|---|
| Mon | | |
| Tue | | |
| Wed | | |
| Thu | | |
| Fri | | |
| Sat | | |
| Sun | | |

## My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I don't belong in church because of my past.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

*Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.*

## Prayer

*Lord, You welcome sinners. Wash me and give me courage to be among Your people. Let my past be a testimony of Your mercy and not a reason to stay away. Amen.*

*Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.*